Lumora Energy to build green hydrogen plant near Valencia

Lumora Energy announced on Tuesday that it will build a green hydrogen plant on the coast south of Valencia. The project is expected to cost 1.2 billion euros and to create around 800 jobs during construction.

Marta Ibarra, chief executive of Lumora Energy, said the site was chosen for its solar capacity and its access to the port. "We want to show that heavy industry can run on sunlight," Marta Ibarra told reporters at the company's headquarters.

Financing will come partly from the European Investment Bank, which has agreed to lend 400 million euros. Daniel Okafor, a vice-president at the European Investment Bank, described the loan as one of the largest clean-energy deals in Spain this year.

The first hydrogen shipments are planned to leave Valencia in 2029, bound for industrial customers of Lumora Energy in Rotterdam. Daniel Okafor said the bank would review progress every six months.

Local business groups welcomed the news, although environmental organisations asked for more detail on water use. Lumora Energy said it would publish a full environmental assessment early next year, and Marta Ibarra promised regular public meetings in Valencia.